English Language Practice Workbook

PAPER 2 WRITING · QUESTION PAPERS

20 Practice Question Papers

Cambridge O Level English Language 1123 format · Time allowed: 2 hours each

Preview

Prepared by PaperBros

Original practice material in the format of Cambridge O Level English Language 1123. Not an official Cambridge publication.

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Each paper follows the Paper 2 Writing format: Section A, Directed Writing (Question 1, 25 marks), and Section B, Composition (one of Questions 2–5, 25 marks). The texts for Question 1 are printed in each paper.

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PREVIEW

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Practice Paper Series

O Level Practice Paper

ENGLISH LANGUAGE **1123/02**

Paper 2 Writing **Practice Paper 01**

2 hours

You must answer on the enclosed answer booklet.

You will need: Answer booklet (enclosed)

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **two** questions in total:
  Section A: answer Question 1.
  Section B: answer **one** question.
- Follow the instructions on the front cover of the answer booklet. If you need additional answer paper, ask the invigilator for a continuation booklet.

INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 50.
- All questions are worth equal marks.

Preview

This document has 4 pages.

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PREVIEW

Section A: Directed Writing

Read **both** texts and answer **Question 1**.

Text 1: A student's view on school uniforms

Student Voices blog

Home Posts About Comments

Every morning I wrestle with a stiff collar and a tie that seems designed to strangle me, and I wonder why we still accept school uniforms without question.

For a start, uniforms are expensive. Our blazer can only be bought from one shop in town, and it costs more than my entire weekend wardrobe. Families with three or four children have to find that money every time someone grows out of a jacket, and second-hand blazers are almost impossible to find.

Uniforms are also impractical. In June, when classrooms are stifling, we sit sweating in thick polyester. Meanwhile, our teachers wear light cotton shirts. How is anyone supposed to concentrate like that?

Worst of all, uniforms crush our individuality. We are told to be creative and think for ourselves, yet we are not trusted to choose our own socks. Teachers waste valuable lesson time checking skirt lengths and handing out detentions for the wrong colour shoes.

Finally, the adult world is changing. Many offices have abandoned suits altogether, and employees are expected to judge for themselves what is appropriate. Learning to dress sensibly is a life skill, and school is the place to practise it.

It's time schools trusted students to make their own choices.

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Text 2: A headteacher's view on school uniforms

Letters to the Editor – The Riverside Times

As a headteacher for over twenty years, I have heard every argument against school uniform, yet I remain convinced that it benefits every student.

Uniform is, above all, a great equaliser. Without it, corridors become a fashion show in which students compete over expensive brands, and those whose families cannot afford the latest trainers are teased or left out. In uniform, nobody can tell who is rich and who is poor.

It also makes mornings simpler. Parents tell me that it prevents arguments at breakfast, and students do not waste time deciding what to wear.

Uniform gives young people a sense of belonging. When our football team walks onto the pitch, students wear our colours with pride. That shared identity encourages good behaviour, because students know they represent the school wherever they go.

Safety matters too. On a crowded school trip, staff can spot our students instantly, and a stranger on the school site stands out at once. Parents value that reassurance more than almost anything.

Finally, most workplaces still have dress codes, from nurses' uniforms to lawyers' suits. Learning to meet those standards now prepares students for the world of work. Uniform is not about control; it is about community.

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Question 1

Your school council is discussing whether school uniform should remain compulsory. After reading the two texts, you decide to give a speech at the next school assembly, giving your views on whether students should have to wear a school uniform.

Write your **speech** for the school assembly.

In your speech, you should:

- evaluate the ideas and opinions in **both** texts
- give your own views about whether school uniform should be compulsory, based on what you have read in the texts.

Base your speech on what you have read in **both** texts but be careful to use your own words.

Address both of the bullet points.

Begin your speech with a suitable greeting.

Write about **250** to **350** words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 15 marks for the quality of your writing. [25]

Preview